

# gemstone-rs BridgeRoot and Object Mapping

A first MagLev-style bridge-root mapping layer over OOPs



Generated from the Markdown sources in `gemstone-rs/docs`.

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# BridgeRoot and Object Mapping

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`gemstone-rs` now has a first object-mapping layer over the lower-level `Oop` API.

This is intentionally smaller than MagLev/GBS object mapping. It gives Rust code a bridge-root dictionary, typed Rust payload mapping, nested read-back, and generated mapping support while keeping direct OOP access available.

## What Is Supported

The initial mapping layer supports:

- `Session::bridge_root()`
- `Session::bridge_root_named(name)`
- `BridgeRoot::put`
- `BridgeRoot::put_mapped`
- `BridgeRoot::get_oop`
- `BridgeRoot::get_value`
- `BridgeRoot::get_string`
- `BridgeRoot::get_smallint`
- `BridgeRoot::get_bool`
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- `BridgeKey`
- `BridgeKeyType::String`
- `BridgeKeyType::Symbol`

- BridgeMapped
- #[derive(BridgeMapped)]
- BridgeFieldRead
- BridgeFieldWrite
- BridgeValue::Nil
- BridgeValue::Bool
- BridgeValue::SmallInt
- BridgeValue::String
- BridgeValue::Symbol
- BridgeValue::Oop
- BridgeValue::Dictionary
- BridgeValue::KeyedDictionary
- BridgeValue::Array
- session-local OOP identity ids with Session::identity\_for\_oop

The default root is a GemStone Dictionary stored in UserGlobals under #GemStoneRsBridgeRoot.

## Rust Example

```
use gemstone_rs::{BridgeValue, Config, Session};

fn main() -> gemstone_rs::Result<()> {
    let mut session = Session::login(Config::from_env())?;

    let payload = BridgeValue::dictionary([
        ("name".to_string(), BridgeValue::from("Tariq")),
        ("amount".to_string(), BridgeValue::from(100_i64)),
        ("currency".to_string(), BridgeValue::from("GBP")),
    ]);

    let mut bridge_root = session.bridge_root()?;
    let payload_oop = bridge_root.put("MyTestDict", payload)?;
    let stored = bridge_root.get_oop("MyTestDict")?;
    assert_eq!(payload_oop, stored);

    bridge_root.commit()?;
    Ok(())
}
```

Run the example:

```
cargo run -p gemstone-rs --example bridge_root_mapping
```

Expected output includes:

```
bridge root: GemStoneRsBridgeRoot
MyTestDict OOP: <number>
```

## Typed Rust Struct Mapping

For application code, implement `BridgeMapped` on a plain Rust type. The trait keeps the mapping explicit and reviewable while removing repeated dictionary field reads from application code.

```
use gemstone_rs::{BridgeDictionary, BridgeMapped, BridgeValue, Config, Session};

#[derive(Debug, Eq, PartialEq)]
struct BookingDraft {
    name: String,
    amount: i64,
    currency: String,
}

impl BridgeMapped for BookingDraft {
    fn to_bridge_value(&self) -> BridgeValue {
        BridgeValue::dictionary([
            ("name".to_string(), BridgeValue::from(self.name.clone())),
            ("amount".to_string(), BridgeValue::from(self.amount)),
            ("currency".to_string(), BridgeValue::from(self.currency.clone())),
        ])
    }

    fn from_bridge_dictionary(dictionary: &mut BridgeDictionary<'_>) ->
    gemstone_rs::Result<Self> {
        Ok(Self {
            name: dictionary.at_string("name")?,
            amount: dictionary.at_smallint("amount")?,
            currency: dictionary.at_string("currency")?,
        })
    }
}

fn main() -> gemstone_rs::Result<()> {
    let mut session = Session::login(Config::from_env())?;
    let mut bridge_root = session.bridge_root()?;

    let draft = BookingDraft {
        name: "Tariq".to_string(),
        amount: 100,
        currency: "GBP".to_string(),
    };

    bridge_root.put_mapped("MyTestDict", &draft)?;
    let loaded: BookingDraft = bridge_root.get_mapped("MyTestDict")?;
    assert_eq!(loaded, draft);

    bridge_root.commit()?;
```

```
Ok(())  
}
```

The checked-in example uses this pattern:

```
cargo run -p gemstone-rs --example bridge_root_mapping
```

Expected output includes:

```
bridge root: GemStoneRsBridgeRoot  
MyTestDict OOP: <number>  
loaded payload: BookingDraft { name: "Tariq", amount: 100, currency: "GBP" }
```

## Derive-Based Mapping

For normal Rust structs, prefer `#[derive(BridgeMapped)]`. The derive writes a `BridgeMapped` implementation that stores fields in a GemStone dictionary and reads them back into Rust.

```
use gemstone_rs::{BridgeMapped, Config, Session};  
use std::collections::BTreeMap;  
  
#[derive(Clone, Debug, Eq, PartialEq, BridgeMapped)]  
struct CustomerDraft {  
    #[bridge(key_type = "Symbol")]  
    name: String,  
}  
  
#[derive(Clone, Debug, Eq, PartialEq, BridgeMapped)]  
struct BookingDraft {  
    #[bridge(key = "amount", key_type = "Symbol")]  
    amount: i64,  
    customer: CustomerDraft,  
    tags: Vec<String>,  
    labels: BTreeMap<String, String>,  
    note: Option<String>,  
}  
  
fn main() -> gemstone_rs::Result<()> {  
    let mut session = Session::login(Config::from_env())?;  
    let mut bridge_root = session.bridge_root()?;  
  
    let draft = BookingDraft {  
        amount: 100,  
        customer: CustomerDraft {  
            name: "Tariq".to_string(),  
        },  
        tags: vec!["priority".to_string(), "demo".to_string()],  
        labels: BTreeMap::from([("source".to_string(), "derive".to_string())]),  
    }  
}
```

```

        note: None,
    };

    bridge_root.put_mapped("DerivedBookingDraft", &draft)?;
    let loaded: BookingDraft = bridge_root.get_mapped("DerivedBookingDraft")?;
    assert_eq!(loaded, draft);

    bridge_root.commit()?;
    Ok(())
}

```

Run the checked-in live example:

```
cargo run -p gemstone-rs --example derive_mapping
```

Expected output includes:

```

derived mapped payload: BookingDraft { amount: 100, customer: CustomerDraft { name:
"Tarig" }, tags: ["priority", "demo"], labels: {"source": "derive"}, note: None }
bridge root identity: <number>

```

## Nested Read-Back

Nested mapped structs and arrays round-trip through the same bridge dictionary format:

| Rust field                  | GemStone storage           | Read-back helper              |
|-----------------------------|----------------------------|-------------------------------|
| String                      | String                     | BridgeFieldRead / at_string   |
| i64                         | SmallInteger               | BridgeFieldRead / at_smallint |
| bool                        | true / false               | BridgeFieldRead / at_bool     |
| Oop                         | raw object reference       | BridgeFieldRead / at_oop      |
| another BridgeMapped struct | nested Dictionary          | BridgeDictionary::at_mapped   |
| Vec<T>                      | Array                      | BridgeDictionary::at_vec      |
| BTreeMap<String, T>         | string-keyed Dictionary    | BridgeDictionary::at_map      |
| Option<T>                   | value, nil, or missing key | BridgeFieldRead               |

This lets a Rust payload keep normal nested shape:

```
#[derive(Clone, Debug, Eq, PartialEq, BridgeMapped)]
struct BookingDraft {
    customer: CustomerDraft,
    tags: Vec<String>,
    labels: BTreeMap<String, String>,
    note: Option<String>,
}
```

Optional fields are useful when a BridgeRoot dictionary evolves over time. `None` writes as `GemStone nil`; read-back returns `None` when the key is missing or when the stored value is `nil`. `Some(value)` reads through the inner field type, so `Option<CustomerDraft>` still reports nested mapping errors with the full field path.

When read-back fails, mapping errors include field context:

```
field amount expected GemStone value type SmallInt, got Oop 1234
field booking.customer.name expected GemStone value type String, got OOP 1234
field tags[2] expected GemStone value type String, got OOP 1234
field labels["source"] expected GemStone value type String, got OOP 1234
```

Nested mapped read-back preserves the full field path, and array read-back reports the failing element index. Both are important when generated mappings read back nested payloads from a live stone. Lookup failures are also wrapped with the current path, so missing keys and invalid nested arrays point at `booking.items` or `booking.items[2]` instead of only returning a generic `GemStone` lookup error.

## Key Policy

`GemStone` dictionaries often use either string keys or symbol keys. The mapping layer makes that explicit:

```
#[derive(Clone, Debug, Eq, PartialEq, BridgeMapped)]
struct BookingDraft {
    #[bridge(key = "amount", key_type = "Symbol")]
    amount: i64,
}
```

Manual code can use the same policy:

```
use gemstone_rs::BridgeKeyType;

bridge_root.put_with_key_type("BookingDraft", BridgeKeyType::Symbol, "stored")?;
let oop = bridge_root.get_oop_with_key_type("BookingDraft", BridgeKeyType::Symbol)?;
```



Use string keys when interoperating with JSON-like payloads and symbol keys when you want Smalltalk-style dictionary access.

## Transactions and Identity

`BridgeRoot::transaction` commits on success and aborts on error:

```
bridge_root.transaction(|root| {
  root.put_mapped("BookingDraft", &draft)?;
  let loaded: BookingDraft = root.get_mapped("BookingDraft"?;
  assert_eq!(loaded, draft);
  Ok(())
})?;
```

For conflict-prone commits, use a bounded retry:

```
bridge_root.put_mapped("BookingDraft", &draft)?;
bridge_root.commit_with_retry(2)?;
```

`Session` also tracks a session-local identity id for OOPs it sees:

```
let oop = bridge_root.get_oop("BookingDraft"?;
let identity = bridge_root.identity_id();
println!("bridge root identity={identity}, payload oop={}", oop.raw());
```

That is not transparent object persistence. It is a stable in-session cache key for wrappers, inspectors, and explorer views.

## Relationship-Shaped Payloads

Use nested structs and vectors when the Rust boundary needs a relationship-like shape but you still want explicit persistence. This keeps the GemStone side a plain dictionary graph and keeps the Rust side strongly typed:

```
use gemstone_rs::BridgeMapped;
use std::collections::BTreeMap;

#[derive(Clone, Debug, Eq, PartialEq, BridgeMapped)]
struct CustomerDraft {
  name: String,
  email: String,
}

#[derive(Clone, Debug, Eq, PartialEq, BridgeMapped)]
```

```

struct LineItemDraft {
    sku: String,
    quantity: i64,
}

#[derive(Clone, Debug, Eq, PartialEq, BridgeMapped)]
struct BookingDraft {
    customer: CustomerDraft,
    items: Vec<LineItemDraft>,
    tags: Vec<String>,
    labels: BTreeMap<String, String>,
    note: Option<String>,
}

```

A failed nested read reports the path that a user would naturally inspect:

```

booking.items[2].customer.name expected GemStone value type String, got OOP 1234

```

This is the practical middle ground between raw OOPs and transparent object persistence: relationships are visible in config and generated Rust source, and the low-level OOP API remains available for special cases.

## Comparison With MagLev/GBS

The MagLev branch example uses:

```

session bridgeRoot at: #MyTestDict put: payload.
session commitTransactionOrSignalConflict

```

The closest current `gemstone-rs` shape is:

```

let mut bridge_root = session.bridge_root()?;
bridge_root.put("MyTestDict", payload)?;
bridge_root.commit()?;

```

For typed Rust structs:

```

bridge_root.put_mapped("MyTestDict", &draft)?;
let loaded: BookingDraft = bridge_root.get_mapped("MyTestDict")?;

```

This is still explicit mapping, not transparent persistence. The benefit is that Rust teams can review every field mapping and still keep direct OOP access available when they need it.

# Codegen Support

`gemstone-rs` codegen can emit `BridgeMapped` structs from config:

```
mapped = BookingDraft | doc=A typed Rust payload stored under BridgeRoot.  
field = BookingDraft.name | type=String | key=name  
field = BookingDraft.amount | type=SmallInt | key=amount | key_type=Symbol  
field = BookingDraft.currency | type=String | key=currency  
field = BookingDraft.tags | type=Vec<String> | key=tags  
field = BookingDraft.labels | type=BTreeMap<String, String> | key=labels  
field = BookingDraft.note | type=Option<String> | key=note
```

Generate a mapping config proposal from a live GemStone class:

```
gemstone-rs codegen discover-mapping gemstone-rs.codegen BookingDraft Object
```

For quick CLI inspection of the bridge root itself:

```
gemstone-rs bridge root  
gemstone-rs bridge keys  
gemstone-rs bridge get BookingDraft --symbol  
gemstone-rs bridge inspect BookingDraft --symbol  
gemstone-rs bridge sample-config BookingDraft
```

Use `--root OtherBridgeRoot` when you intentionally use a non-default root dictionary, and `--key-type String|Symbol` when you want the key policy to be spelled out in scripts.

`bridge keys` lists each root key with its key OOP, class OOP, `printString`, and session-local identity id.

Run the live discovery example:

```
cargo run -p gemstone-rs --example codegen_discover_mapping
```

Run the generated mapping example:

```
cargo run -p gemstone-rs --example generated_mapping_app
```

This is the recommended path for repeated mappings because the generated source is checked in and reviewed like any other Rust code.

# Explorer and VS Code Support

The local explorer exposes BridgeRoot-oriented endpoints:

```
curl -s http://127.0.0.1:8787/api/bridge/root
curl -s http://127.0.0.1:8787/api/bridge/keys
curl -s 'http://127.0.0.1:8787/api/bridge/get?key=BookingDraft'
curl -s 'http://127.0.0.1:8787/api/bridge/put?key=WorkbenchDraft&value=hello'
curl -s 'http://127.0.0.1:8787/api/bridge/remove?key=WorkbenchDraft'
curl -s 'http://127.0.0.1:8787/api/bridge/mapping-config?mapped=BookingDraft'
curl -s 'http://127.0.0.1:8787/api/codegen/discover-mapping?
mapped=BookingDraft&class=Object'
```

The write endpoints require `gemstone-rs-explorer --allow-write`. Without that flag they return HTTP 403, matching the explorer's read-only default.

The VS Code workbench adds the same object-mapping workflow:

- GemStone RS: Generate Mapping Config
- GemStone RS: Preview BridgeRoot
- GemStone RS: List BridgeRoot Keys
- GemStone RS: Put BridgeRoot String
- GemStone RS: Remove BridgeRoot Key
- GemStone RS: Run Generated Mapping Example

The sidebar also shows these actions under `Codegen Config`.

## Current Boundaries

The mapping layer is explicit, not transparent persistence. It does not yet make every GemStone object look like a native Rust object automatically. The current design is deliberately conservative:

- `Oop` remains visible and available.
- `Session` is still non-`Send` and non-`Sync`.
- writes happen only through explicit `put`, `put_mapped`, or generated code.
- the identity map is session-local and does not replace GemStone identity.

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